



Division Policy

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VERSION 1.0

WARNING!

Information contained in this document is intended
for flight simulation purposes only.

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Purpose of Document

This document constitutes the formal Division Policy for VATSIM Sub-Saharan Africa (VATSSA). It establishes the governance framework, structural hierarchy, and professional standards governing all divisional participants and operations.

This policy has been developed to achieve the following objectives:

- Define the divisional governance structure, organisational hierarchy, and staff obligations.
- Establish clear standards for all personnel and members engaged in divisional operations.
- Promote a transparent, equitable, and professional environment across the entire membership.
- Provide direction on network operations, airspace management, and ATC protocols within the region.
- Set out the framework for training, documentation, and operational procedures.

VATSSA is committed to fostering a safe, collaborative, and professional environment for all participants, regardless of their divisional affiliation. This policy is binding for all members and visitors utilising VATSSA infrastructure or participating in divisional operations.

1. Control Pages

1.1. Document Identification

Type	Policy
Revision	05/2026
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Prepared By	Wian Saptouw – VATSSA1 (Division Director), Luke Van Zyl & Josh Martin
Approved By	Wian Saptouw – VATSSA1 (Division Director)
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1.2. Revision Records

Version	Date	Description	Author
1.0	05/2026	Initial Policy Drafted	Josh Martin & Wian Saptouw

2. General Provisions

2.1. Applicability

This policy applies to all VATSIM members whose home division is VATSSA, all VATSSA staff members, visiting controllers authorised to operate within VATSSA airspace, and any individual making use of VATSSA infrastructure, services, or divisional platforms.

This policy applies in all divisional contexts, including online controlling sessions, divisional events, training activities, staff operations, and communications conducted through official VATSSA channels.

2.2. Non-Compliance

Any member found to be in violation of this policy may be subject to disciplinary action. VATSSA Senior Leadership retains full authority to enforce the provisions of this policy against any individual in breach thereof. The nature and severity of any action taken will be proportionate to the violation.

2.3. Changes

This policy is subject to periodic review and amendment. Amendments may be made by VATSSA Senior Leadership as required to address its clarity and effectiveness. Members will be expected to comply with the most current published version of this policy, which will be published at vatssa.com.

3. Definitions

Term	Definition
VATSSA	VATSIM Sub-Saharan Africa — the Division governing the Sub-Saharan Africa region within VATEMEA.
VATEMEA	Europe, Middle East & Africa — the VATSIM Region under which VATSSA falls.
VATSIM	Virtual Air Traffic Simulation Network — the overarching network governing all virtual airspace.
BoG	VATSIM Board of Governors — the governing body of VATSIM.
Division Director (VATSSA1)	The appointed head of VATSSA, responsible for all strategic decisions and communications with VATEMEA.
Deputy Division Director (VATSSA2)	The deputy to the Division Director, responsible for divisional coordination and department oversight.
Division Staff	Any VATSSA member holding an official staff role within the division.
Operations Team	A voluntary support layer within the division, below staff level, who assist with divisional operations. Open to applications year-round.
Member	Any VATSIM member who has VATSSA as their home division.
Visiting Controller	A controller from another division who is authorised to control within VATSSA airspace.

4. VATSSA Organisation

VATSSA, VATSIM Sub-Sahara Africa Division, is the community covering the local VATSIM facilities based in Sub-Saharan Africa. VATSSA falls under the VATEMEA region. VATEMEA covers Europe, Middle East & Africa, one of the three VATSIM Regions managed by the VATSIM Board of Governors (BoG). The other regions are VATAMAS, Americas and VATAPAC, Asia Pacific.

This policy serves as the base guidelines and regulations for all members and staff within VATSSA. The division is responsible for the following countries and territories:

- Angola
- Zambia
- Tanzania
- DRC
- Congo
- Gabon
- Guinea
- Equatorial Guinea
- Cameroon
- CAF
- Uganda
- Kenya
- Nigeria
- Burkina Faso
- Equatorial Guinea
- Senegal
- Sierra Leone
- Liberia
- Ivory
- Ghana
- Togo
- Benin
- Seychelles
- St Helena
- ZAI
- Mauritania
- Rwanda
- Mauritius
- Madagascar
- Lesotho
- Swaziland
- Mozambique
- Malawi

- Zimbabwe
- Botswana
- Namibia
- Burundi
- Sao Tome and Principe

VATSIM is the highest entity that owns the virtual airspace of the network, the organisation of the airspace has been delegated to the Regions, which then falls in the hands of the Divisions.

4.1 Division Structure

The VATSSA Division has a staff structure consisting of different departments that maintain the services, policies, and regulations of the division. All teams and members of the staff work on a voluntary basis. None of the services are professional services and members work in their free time. Any tasks or services may take time to be processed.

4.2. Staff Age Requirements

Given the substantial obligations inherent to divisional leadership, all personnel must have attained a minimum age of 16 years at the time of their induction. The Division Director maintains the prerogative to grant individual exemptions to this prerequisite should circumstances necessitate such action

Role	Identifiers	Key Responsibilities
Division Director	VATSSA1	Define Division strategy and goals. Oversee all departments. Maintain communication with VATEMEA.
Deputy Division Director	VATSSA2	Report to VATSSA1. Coordinate all departments.
ATC Training Manager	VATSSA3	Manage all ATC training initiatives. Oversee mentor and examiner development. Requires C1 rating.
Membership Manager	VATSSA4	Process rating updates and transfer requests. Maintain the VATSSA Discord Server. Support member engagement and retention.
Events Manager	VATSSA5	Develop an event calendar. Coordinate events. Promote and market events. Coordinate with other divisions.
rVA Manager	VATSSA6	Maintain communication with partner virtual airlines. Assist Events Manager in planning VA events.
Tech Manager	VATSSA7	Coordinate sector files and eAIP. Maintain GitHub, AFV, GNG. Maintain web services.
Deputy ATC Manager	VATSSA8	Assist the ATC Training Manager
Deputy Events Manager	VATSSA9	Assist the Events Manager
Deputy rVA Manager	VATSSA10	Assist the rVA Manager
Deputy Membership Manager	VATSSA11	Assist the Membership Manager
Deputy Tech Manager	VATSSA12	Assist the Tech Manager

4.3. Department Head Requirements

The following roles are designated as Department Head positions within the division:

- Division Director (VATSSA1)
- Deputy Division Director (VATSSA2)
- ATC Training Manager - (Requires C1 rating)
- Membership Manager
- Events Manager
- rVA Manager
- Tech Manager

4.4. Division Director

The Regional Director of VATEMEA appoints the Division Director (VATSSA1), who subsequently designates a Deputy Division Director. As the primary executive of VATSSA, the Division Director is tasked with:

- Establishing the overarching divisional goals and strategic direction.
- Supervising all departmental functions to ensure mandate fulfillment.
- Acting as the principal liaison for communication with VATEMEA leadership.
- Ratifying all divisional regulatory documents and subsequent revisions.
- Managing the appointment and removal of all staff personnel.

Should the Division Director vacate the office, formal notification must be provided to divisional staff and the VATEMEA Vice President. VATEMEA is responsible for identifying a successor; in the interim, the Deputy Division Director shall assume leadership as Acting Director in conjunction with regional oversight.

4.5. Deputy Division Director

Reporting directly to VATSSA1, the Deputy Division Director (VATSSA2) this position is responsible for:

- Providing comprehensive support and reporting to the Division Director.
- Ensuring operational synergy through the coordination of various departments.

The Deputy Division Director role is separate from department staff roles . Where both roles are held by the same individual, each role carries its own distinct obligations and lines of accountability.

4.6. Departmental Teams

Divisional activities are organized into specialized departments, comprising:

- ATC Training
- Membership
- Events
- rVA Relations
- Technical Services

These departmental units address specific divisional interests and maintain close collaboration with divisional leadership. While staff members may participate in multiple departments, they are restricted to holding only one leadership position at any given time.

4.7. Absence from Divisional Duties

During a staff member's absence, their respective deputy shall assume all departmental duties. If no deputy exists, the responsibility ascends to the next organizational level unless the Division Director specifies an alternative arrangement.

Personnel unable to attend scheduled meetings may designate a proxy to vote on their behalf, provided this is formally communicated via email or official divisional channels before the commencement of the meeting.

4.8. Leaving Divisional Staff

Individuals resigning from divisional positions must notify the Division Director and their immediate deputy. To ensure divisional continuity, a smooth handover is required, and early notification is strongly encouraged to facilitate the recruitment of a successor.

Upon departure, all data acquired during the tenure of the position must be transferred to the incoming successor or the relevant superior staff member.

When a staff position becomes vacant, the following procedure applies:

- The deputy of the vacant role shall immediately assume the responsibilities of that position in an acting capacity.
- The acting appointment is temporary and does not constitute a permanent promotion.
- A formal recruitment process must be initiated as soon as practicable following the vacancy arising.
- The acting staff member is entitled to apply for the position through the formal process on equal terms with all other applicants.
- The permanent appointment will only be made following the conclusion of the formal recruitment process, in accordance with Section 9 of this policy.

Note: *Bypassing the formal recruitment process by making an immediate permanent appointment — even of an internal candidate — is not consistent with this policy. The acting arrangement exists precisely to allow a fair and open process to take place without operational disruption.*

4.9. Staff Working Ethics

All personnel must acknowledge that divisional contributions are voluntary and represent a personal commitment of leisure time to the hobby. Typical staff roles may require an investment of approximately five hours weekly to fulfill administrative requirements.

To maintain divisional standards, staff are expected to maintain a regular presence on the network, keep their work updated, and engage in consistent communication with their divisional colleagues.

5. Network Operations

5.1. Overview

VATSSA is responsible for the administration and operation of virtual airspace within its geographic scope, as delegated by VATSIM. All network activities conducted within VATSSA airspace must comply with this policy and with applicable VATSIM regulations.

5.2. Airspace Management

All airspace within the VATSSA geographic scope is administered by the division. VATSSA is responsible for:

- Maintaining accurate and current sector file data for all facilities within the region.
- Coordinating with VATSIM on airspace boundaries, delegations, and operational matters.
- Ensuring that electronic AIP (eAIP) information is kept up to date and accessible.
- Facilitating operational continuity through the Technical Services department.

5.3. Approved Controlling Positions

Controllers operating within VATSSA airspace may only staff positions that are officially configured and published by the division. An approved position is one that is:

- Configured in Audio for VATSIM (AFV) with a designated frequency.
- Included in the current VATSSA sector file.
- Listed on the official VATSSA website or published position database.

The following variations of approved positions are also permitted where applicable:

- Approved mentoring positions, as designated by the ATC Training Department for use during supervised training sessions.
- Approved examination positions, as designated for use during Controller Practical Tests (CPTs).

Controllers may only transmit on the frequencies designated for their approved position as published in the divisional configuration. Use of non-published frequencies, self-assigned callsigns, or positions not appearing in the divisional configuration is not permitted.

5.4 ATC Operations

All controlling activity within VATSSA airspace must comply with VATSIM regulations and VATSSA procedures. Controllers are expected to:

- Control only within the scope of their approved rating and any applicable endorsements.
- Adhere to published VATSSA procedures and phraseology standards.

- Maintain professional conduct during all online sessions.
- Report operational irregularities or technical issues to the relevant staff member.

5.5. Pilot Operations

Pilots operating within VATSSA airspace are expected to comply with published procedures for the region, conduct themselves professionally, and follow the instructions of ATC where applicable. VATSSA does not place restrictions on pilot activity beyond those established by VATSIM.

6. Permission to Control

6.1. Home Controller

Members whose home division is VATSSA may control within VATSSA airspace provided they hold the appropriate VATSIM ATC rating for the position being staffed, and have satisfied any additional divisional training or endorsement requirements applicable to that position.

6.2. Visiting Controllers

Controllers from other VATSIM divisions may request permission to control within VATSSA airspace as visiting controllers. To be granted visiting control rights, a visiting controller must:

- Hold a valid VATSIM ATC rating of S3 or above.
- Submit a formal request through the appropriate VATSSA channel.
- Satisfy any competency or familiarisation requirements stipulated by VATSSA for the facility concerned.

VATSSA reserves the right to grant, suspend, or revoke visiting control permissions at its discretion. Visiting controllers are subject to the same conduct and operational standards as home controllers while operating within VATSSA airspace, including the requirement to staff only approved positions on designated frequencies

6.3. Endorsements

Certain positions within VATSSA may require additional endorsements beyond the standard VATSIM rating. These endorsements are administered by the ATC Training Manager and will be communicated through official divisional channels.

7. ATC and Pilot Training

7.1. ATC Training

VATSSA provides ATC training to eligible members through its ATC Training department, overseen by the ATC Training Manager. The ATC Training department is responsible for:

- Recruiting, developing, and managing mentors and examiners.

- Administering theory and practical assessments for controller rating progression.
- Maintaining training records and progression documentation.
- Ensuring training materials are current and aligned with applicable standards.

7.2 Pilot Training

VATSSA supports pilot training within the region through coordination with partner virtual airlines (rVAs) and the Events department. The division supports pilot development by:

- Coordinating with rVA partners on pilot training initiatives and events.
- Facilitating controlled environments where pilots can practise procedures.
- Promoting realistic and procedurally correct pilot operations within the region.

7.3 Training Standards

All training conducted under the VATSSA banner must align with VATSIM training standards. The ATC Training Manager holds authority over training delivery and may introduce supplemental divisional standards where necessary.

8. Documentation and Procedures

8.1. Policy and Procedure Documents

VATSSA maintains a suite of divisional documents governing specific areas of operation. These documents are developed, maintained, and approved by the relevant department heads and the Division Director. All divisional documents are published at vatssa.com and are subject to periodic review.

8.2. Sector Files and eAIP

VATSSA maintains sector files and electronic AIP data for all facilities within its airspace. These are administered by the Tech Manager (VATSSA7) and are made available to members through

official divisional channels. Members who identify inaccuracies are encouraged to report these to the Tech Manager through the appropriate channel.

8.3. Document Authority

All documents published under the VATSSA name must be approved by the Division Director prior to publication. The Division Director may delegate document approval to department heads for documents within their area of responsibility.

9. Staff and Team Operations Selection

This section establishes the formal procedures governing the recruitment and selection of personnel within the VATSSA Division, covering both staff roles and the ops team. The leadership is committed to a rigorous and impartial evaluation framework, ensuring that all candidates are assessed solely on merit to preclude any instances of bias or preferential treatment throughout the recruitment lifecycle.

VATSSA maintains the absolute prerogative to decline any applicant deemed incompatible with the requirements of the designated position.

9.1. Team Operations

The VATSSA ops team is a voluntary support layer below staff level. Ops team members assist with divisional operations and may be considered for internal staff vacancies in accordance with Section 9.3.

Applications to the ops team are accepted year-round. There is no fixed recruitment window. The process works as follows:

- Any VATSSA member in good standing may submit an application to join the ops team at any time via the designated application email.
- Applications are reviewed by VATSSA1 and VATSSA2. Where an immediate opening is available, the applicant will be assessed and onboarded accordingly.
- Where no immediate opening exists, the application will be placed on a waiting list and considered when capacity becomes available.
- Applicants on the waiting list will be notified of their position and informed when their application is being actively considered.
- The ops team selection process is subject to the same anti-bias and fairness standards as staff selection. Applications are assessed on merit, without regard to existing affiliations.

Note: *Being placed on the waiting list does not guarantee an ops team position. VATSSA reserves the right to manage team size in line with operational needs.*

9.2. Internal Hiring Preference

Where a staff vacancy arises and a suitable internal candidate exists within the divisional staff or ops team, VATSSA will give preference to internal hiring before opening the position to external applicants. Internal hiring must be conducted under the following conditions:

- The internal candidate must genuinely meet the requirements of the role.
- The selection process must be documented and transparent.
- All decisions must be reviewed by both VATSSA1 and VATSSA2 independently.
- Where there is any perceived conflict of interest, a third staff member must be designated to provide an independent assessment.
- If no suitable internal candidate exists, or if internal hiring cannot be conducted without bias, the position must be advertised externally.

Note: *Internal hiring is governed in full alignment with the VATSSA Staff Conduct Policy. Any instance of favouritism, preferential treatment, or undue influence constitutes a breach of divisional policy and will be treated accordingly.*

9.3. Roles and Responsibilities

Division Director (VATSSA1):

- Governs the overarching recruitment strategy for the divisional staff team.
- Provides final ratification for all personnel recommendations.
- Identifies critical personnel requirements and organisational vacancies.
- Presides over all formal candidate interviews.

Deputy Division Director (VATSSA2):

- Acts in a supportive capacity and reports directly to VATSSA1.
- Assists in the identification of divisional staffing needs.
- Manages the scheduling and logistical coordination of interviews.
- Submits formal recommendations of qualified candidates to the Division Director.
- Facilitates the publication of vacancy notices and divisional advertisements.

9.4. Vacancy Identification

The determination of organisational vacancies is conducted through the joint oversight of VATSSA1 and VATSSA2.

9.5. Advertisement Process

Official recruitment notices shall be advertised via the following divisional channels:

- The designated Staff Openings channel on the Discord server.
- The official VATSIM Vacancies community forum.

All recruitment notices must include: the formal title of the position, Discord role designation, reporting line, primary obligations, requisite competencies, and the application submission deadline. Formal notification shall be provided to VATEMEA for all filled vacancies involving senior staff appointments.

9.6. Application Process

- Prospective candidates must submit their formal applications to the designated email address prior to the expiration of the closing period.
- The leadership retains the right to summarily reject any submissions received after the established deadline.
- Applications will be independently reviewed by both VATSSA1 and VATSSA2, with optional evaluation by an additional qualified staff member.
- Candidates who fulfil the preliminary requirements will be invited to a formal interview conducted by a panel of at least two staff members.
- Selected applicants will receive direct communication from divisional leadership to commence the onboarding sequence.

9.7. Decision Process

The final selection is overseen by VATSSA1 and VATSSA2, with applicants assessed on criteria including, but not limited to:

- Professional Curriculum Vitae (CV).
- Technical competencies and pertinent skills.
- Performance demonstrated during the interview phase.
- Formal internal staff recommendations.
- Historical and current professional experience.
- Behavioural standing and disciplinary record within the division.
- Prior contributions and engagement with divisional activities.

All applicants retain the right to withdraw from the selection process at any juncture. Divisional leadership shall provide notification to all applicants regarding the ultimate outcome of their submission.

9.8. Mitigation of Bias and Favouritism

- Successful passage of the initial screening phase necessitates a formal interview for all candidates.
- Applications are reviewed in an impartial sequence in strict accordance with divisional policy.
- Dual independent assessments are mandated for every applicant by the Director and Deputy Director.
- A third staff member may be designated to provide an additional layer of objective evaluation.
- Selection is predicated entirely on an individual's suitability for the role, regardless of existing internal affiliations.

10. Authority

- This policy is enforced by the VATSSA Leadership Department and authorised by the Division Director.
- Decisions made under this policy are final unless otherwise stated by VATSSA procedures.

11. Review and Amendments

- This policy is subject to periodic review to ensure continued relevance and effectiveness, or when otherwise requested by the Division Director.
- Amendments to this policy may be made by the VATSSA Leadership Department as required.
- Members will be expected to comply with the most current published version of this policy, published at vatssa.com.

